

FIELD NOTES: SCIENCE VOCABULARY

Sneak Peek: What's Dropping This Year

New videos, infographics, and podcast episodes go live every Sunday at 9 AM — one topic at a time, right alongside what each grade is learning that week. Here's the full lineup of all **316 episodes**, one for every Core vocabulary term across Grades 6–8.

This schedule is mapped to St. Mary School's actual 2026–27 calendar, week by week with no gaps — Christmas Break (Dec 20 & 27) and Easter Break (Mar 28) both appear as their own rows below, clearly marked as journal catch-up weeks with no new drops.

Grades 6 and 7 finish their regular vocabulary by Week 37. Grade 8 also finishes its vocabulary at Week 37 — and that same week carries the **Journey Finale**, since Grade 8's final term, Ellipse, lands on Episode 316, the very last episode of the entire journey. Week 38 (May 23, 2027) is a shared wrap-up week with no new drops.

Grade	Elevate Course	Core Terms	Episode Range
Grade 6	Course 1	86	Ep. 001–086
Grade 7	Course 2	108	Ep. 087–194
Grade 8	Course 3	122	Ep. 195–316

Episode numbers above run separately per grade — each grade's own 001 through its final term — matching what's shown on the Field Guide site. All three grades combined still add up to the full 316-term journey.

CURRICULUM MAP

Topic order and pacing per grade, mapped to the actual 2026–27 St. Mary School calendar.

Grade 6

Topic	Weeks	Dates	Terms
Introduction to Matter	Wk 1–4	Aug 16 – Sep 6	10
Solids, Liquids, and Gases	Wk 5–9	Sep 13 – Oct 11	11
Energy	Wk 10–14	Oct 18 – Nov 15	14
Thermal Energy	Wk 15–18	Nov 22 – Dec 13	8
Introduction to Earth's Systems	Wk 19–20	Jan 3 – Jan 10	4
Weather in the Atmosphere	Wk 21–25	Jan 17 – Feb 14	12
Minerals and Rocks in the Geosphere	Wk 26–27	Feb 21 – Feb 28	5
Plate Tectonics	Wk 28–29	Mar 7 – Mar 14	5
Earth's Surface Systems	Wk 30–33	Mar 21 – Apr 18	8
Living Things in the Biosphere	Wk 34–37	Apr 25 – May 16	9

Grade 7

Topic	Weeks	Dates	Terms
The Cell System	Wk 1–8	Aug 16 – Oct 4	23
Human Body Systems	Wk 9–13	Oct 11 – Nov 8	14
Reproduction and Growth	Wk 14–15	Nov 15 – Nov 22	7
Ecosystems	Wk 16–19	Nov 29 – Jan 3	10
Populations, Communities, and Ecosystems	Wk 20–24	Jan 10 – Feb 7	15
Distribution of Natural Resources	Wk 25–26	Feb 14 – Feb 21	5
Human Impacts on the Environment	Wk 27–29	Feb 28 – Mar 14	9
Waves and Electromagnetic Radiation	Wk 30–33	Mar 21 – Apr 18	11
Electricity and Magnetism	Wk 34–36	Apr 25 – May 9	10
Information Technologies	Wk 37	May 16	4

Grade 8

Topic	Weeks	Dates	Terms
Atoms and the Periodic Table	Wk 1–7	Aug 16 – Sep 27	22
Chemical Reactions	Wk 8–10	Oct 4 – Oct 18	9
Forces and Motion	Wk 11–14	Oct 25 – Nov 15	12
Genes and Heredity	Wk 15–21	Nov 22 – Jan 17	25
Natural Selection and Change Over Time	Wk 22–25	Jan 24 – Feb 14	13
History of Earth	Wk 26–27	Feb 21 – Feb 28	8
Energy in the Atmosphere and Ocean	Wk 28	Mar 7	4

Climate	Wk 29–30	Mar 14 – Mar 21	7
Earth-Sun-Moon System	Wk 31–33	Apr 4 – Apr 18	10
Solar System and the Universe — Journey Finale (Ep. 316)	Wk 34–37	Apr 25 – May 16	12

WEEKLY DROP SCHEDULE

Every Sunday at 9 AM, mapped to the real St. Mary School calendar — no gaps. Each cell shows that week's episode numbers first, then the topic and terms. Episode numbers run separately per grade, matching the Field Guide site (Grade 6: Ep.001–086 · Grade 7: Ep.087–194 · Grade 8: Ep.195–316). Gold row is the Grade 8 Journey Finale week; green rows are break catch-up weeks.

Week / Date	Grade 6	Grade 7	Grade 8
Wk 1 Aug 16	EP.001–003 Introduction to Matter Matter, Atom, Molecule	EP.087–089 The Cell System Cell, Cell Theory, Cell Membrane	EP.195–198 Atoms and the Periodic Table Atom, Atomic Number, Atomic Mass, Proton
Wk 2 Aug 23	EP.004–006 Introduction to Matter Element, Compound, Physical Property	EP.090–092 The Cell System Cell Wall, Cytoplasm, Nucleus	EP.199–201 Atoms and the Periodic Table Neutron, Electron, Periodic Table
Wk 3 Aug 30	EP.007–008 Introduction to Matter Chemical Property, Physical Change	EP.093–095 The Cell System Mitochondria, Chloroplast, Chlorophyll	EP.202–204 Atoms and the Periodic Table Group, Period, Chemical Symbol
Wk 4 Sep 6	EP.009–010 Introduction to Matter Chemical Change, Density	EP.096–098 The Cell System Vacuole, Photosynthesis, Cellular Respiration	EP.205–207 Atoms and the Periodic Table Isotope, Ion, Valence Electron
Wk 5 Sep 13	EP.011–013 Solids, Liquids, and Gases State of Matter, Solid, Liquid	EP.099–101 The Cell System Autotroph, Heterotroph, Cell Cycle	EP.208–210 Atoms and the Periodic Table Ionic Bond, Covalent Bond, Polar Bond
Wk 6 Sep 20	EP.014–015 Solids, Liquids, and Gases Gas, Melting Point	EP.102–104 The Cell System Mitosis, Cytokinesis, Interphase	EP.211–213 Atoms and the Periodic Table Nonpolar Bond, Chemical Bond, Element
Wk 7 Sep 27	EP.016–017 Solids, Liquids, and Gases Freezing Point, Boiling Point	EP.105–107 The Cell System Diffusion, Osmosis, Selectively Permeable	EP.214–216 Atoms and the Periodic Table Compound, Molecule, Polyatomic Ion
Wk 8 Oct 4	EP.018–019 Solids, Liquids, and Gases Condensation, Evaporation	EP.108–109 The Cell System Endocytosis, Exocytosis	EP.217–219 Chemical Reactions Chemical Change, Chemical Reaction, Reactant
Wk 9 Oct 11	EP.020–021 Solids, Liquids, and Gases Sublimation, Vaporization	EP.110–112 Human Body Systems Organ, Tissue, Organ System	EP.220–222 Chemical Reactions Product, Endothermic Reaction, Exothermic Reaction
Wk 10 Oct 18	EP.022–024 Energy Energy, Kinetic Energy, Potential Energy	EP.113–115 Human Body Systems Homeostasis, Circulatory System, Digestion	EP.223–225 Chemical Reactions Law Of Conservation Of Mass, Synthetic, Polymer
Wk 11 Oct 25	EP.025–029 Energy Motion, Power, Gravitational Potential Energy, Elastic Potential Energy, Mechanical Energy	EP.116–118 Human Body Systems Excretion, Response, Stimulus	EP.226–228 Forces and Motion Motion, Speed, Velocity
Wk 12 Nov 1	EP.030–031 Energy Force, Work	EP.119–121 Human Body Systems Reflex, Neuron, Brain	EP.229–231 Forces and Motion Acceleration, Force, Net Force
Wk 13 Nov 8	EP.032–033 Energy Chemical Energy, Electrical Energy	EP.122–123 Human Body Systems Spinal Cord, Synapse	EP.232–234 Forces and Motion Friction, Gravity, Law Of Universal Gravitation

Week / Date	Grade 6	Grade 7	Grade 8
Wk 14 Nov 15	EP.034–035 Energy Nuclear Energy, Law Of Conservation Of Energy	EP.124–127 Reproduction and Growth Asexual Reproduction, Sexual Reproduction, Fertilization, Internal Fertilization	EP.235–237 Forces and Motion Reference Point, Inertia, Newton
Wk 15 Nov 22	EP.036–037 Thermal Energy Thermal Energy, Temperature	EP.128–130 Reproduction and Growth External Fertilization, Zygote, Embryo	EP.238–241 Genes and Heredity Gene, Chromosome, Dna, Heredity
Wk 16 Nov 29	EP.038–039 Thermal Energy Heat, Conduction	EP.131–133 Ecosystems Ecosystem, Producer, Consumer	EP.242–245 Genes and Heredity Trait, Dominant Allele, Recessive Allele, Genotype
Wk 17 Dec 6	EP.040–041 Thermal Energy Convection, Radiation	EP.134–136 Ecosystems Decomposer, Food Chain, Food Web	EP.246–249 Genes and Heredity Phenotype, Pedigree, Sex Chromosomes, Sex-Linked Gene
Wk 18 Dec 13	EP.042–043 Thermal Energy Insulator, Conductor	EP.137–138 Ecosystems Energy Pyramid, Abiotic Factor	EP.250–253 Genes and Heredity Autosomal Chromosomes, Mutation, Mitosis, Meiosis
Dec 20	<i>Christmas Break — journal catch-up, no new drops</i>	<i>Christmas Break — journal catch-up, no new drops</i>	<i>Christmas Break — journal catch-up, no new drops</i>
Dec 27	<i>Christmas Break — journal catch-up, no new drops</i>	<i>Christmas Break — journal catch-up, no new drops</i>	<i>Christmas Break — journal catch-up, no new drops</i>
Wk 19 Jan 3	EP.044–045 Introduction to Earth's Systems Geosphere, Hydrosphere	EP.139–140 Ecosystems Biotic Factor, Habitat	EP.254–256 Genes and Heredity Chromatid, Messenger Rna, Transfer Rna
Wk 20 Jan 10	EP.046–047 Introduction to Earth's Systems Atmosphere, Biosphere	EP.141–143 Populations, Communities, and Ecosystems Population, Community, Biodiversity	EP.257–259 Genes and Heredity Protein Synthesis, Genetic Engineering, Gene Therapy
Wk 21 Jan 17	EP.048–050 Weather in the Atmosphere Weather, Air Mass, Front	EP.144–146 Populations, Communities, and Ecosystems Carrying Capacity, Limiting Factor, Competition	EP.260–262 Genes and Heredity Genome, Clone, Probability
Wk 22 Jan 24	EP.051–053 Weather in the Atmosphere Air Pressure, Humidity, Precipitation	EP.147–149 Populations, Communities, and Ecosystems Predation, Symbiosis, Mutualism	EP.263–266 Natural Selection and Change Over Time Evolution, Natural Selection, Adaptation, Fossil Record
Wk 23 Jan 31	EP.054–055 Weather in the Atmosphere Wind, Storm	EP.150–152 Populations, Communities, and Ecosystems Commensalism, Parasitism, Succession	EP.267–269 Natural Selection and Change Over Time Fossil, Artificial Selection, Fitness
Wk 24 Feb 7	EP.056–057 Weather in the Atmosphere Hurricane, Tornado	EP.153–155 Populations, Communities, and Ecosystems Pioneer Species, Invasive Species, Keystone Species	EP.270–272 Natural Selection and Change Over Time Variation, Homologous Structures, Extinct
Wk 25 Feb 14	EP.058–059 Weather in the Atmosphere Thunderstorm, Flood	EP.156–158 Distribution of Natural Resources Natural Resource, Nonrenewable Resource, Renewable Resource	EP.273–275 Natural Selection and Change Over Time Mass Extinction, Coevolution, Sexual Selection
Wk 26 Feb 21	EP.060–062 Minerals and Rocks in the Geosphere Mineral, Rock Cycle, Igneous Rock	EP.159–160 Distribution of Natural Resources Fossil Fuel, Ore	EP.276–279 History of Earth Geologic Time Scale, Era, Absolute Age, Relative Age

Week / Date	Grade 6	Grade 7	Grade 8
Wk 27 Feb 28	EP.063–064 Minerals and Rocks in the Geosphere Sedimentary Rock, Metamorphic Rock	EP.161–163 Human Impacts on the Environment Pollution, Conservation, Sustainability	EP.280–283 History of Earth Radioactive Dating, Radioactive Decay, Law Of Superposition, Unconformity
Wk 28 Mar 7	EP.065–067 Plate Tectonics Continental Drift, Earthquake, Volcano	EP.164–166 Human Impacts on the Environment Sustainable, Sustainable Use, Emissions	EP.284–287 Energy in the Atmosphere and Ocean Current, Coriolis Effect, Land Breeze, Sea Breeze
Wk 29 Mar 14	EP.068–069 Plate Tectonics Fault, Tsunami	EP.167–169 Human Impacts on the Environment Thermal Pollution, Acid Rain, Ozone	EP.288–291 Climate Climate, Climate Change, Global Warming, Greenhouse Effect
Wk 30 Mar 21	EP.070–071 Earth's Surface Systems Mechanical Weathering, Chemical Weathering	EP.170–172 Waves and Electromagnetic Radiation Wave, Amplitude, Wavelength	EP.292–294 Climate Greenhouse Gas, El Nino, La Nina
Mar 28	<i>Easter Break — journal catch-up, no new drops</i>	<i>Easter Break — journal catch-up, no new drops</i>	<i>Easter Break — journal catch-up, no new drops</i>
Wk 31 Apr 4	EP.072–073 Earth's Surface Systems Soil, Humus	EP.173–175 Waves and Electromagnetic Radiation Frequency, Mechanical Wave, Electromagnetic Wave	EP.295–298 Earth-Sun-Moon System Rotation, Revolution, Axis, Tide
Wk 32 Apr 11	EP.074–075 Earth's Surface Systems Erosion, Deposition	EP.176–178 Waves and Electromagnetic Radiation Electromagnetic Spectrum, Electromagnetic Radiation, Visible Light	EP.299–301 Earth-Sun-Moon System Spring Tide, Neap Tide, Phase
Wk 33 Apr 18	EP.076–077 Earth's Surface Systems Sediment, Glacier	EP.179–180 Waves and Electromagnetic Radiation Reflection, Refraction	EP.302–304 Earth-Sun-Moon System Eclipse, Umbra, Penumbra
Wk 34 Apr 25	EP.078–080 Living Things in the Biosphere Organism, Cell, Classification	EP.181–184 Electricity and Magnetism Electric Force, Electric Field, Magnetic Force, Magnetic Field	EP.305–307 Solar System and the Universe Solar System, Planet, Star
Wk 35 May 2	EP.081–082 Living Things in the Biosphere Species, Virus	EP.185–187 Electricity and Magnetism Electromagnetism, Electromagnet, Electrical Circuit	EP.308–310 Solar System and the Universe Galaxy, Orbit, Sun
Wk 36 May 9	EP.083–084 Living Things in the Biosphere Bacteria, Protist	EP.188–190 Electricity and Magnetism Electric Current, Voltage, Resistance	EP.311–313 Solar System and the Universe Moon, Asteroid, Comet
Wk 37 May 16	EP.085–086 Living Things in the Biosphere Multicellular, Unicellular	EP.191–194 Information Technologies Signal, Digital Signal, Analog Signal, Information Technology	EP.314–316 Solar System and the Universe — Journey Finale Meteor, Meteoroid, Ellipse
Wk 38 May 23	<i>No new drop — Journey Finale already aired (Grade 8, Wk 37)</i>	<i>No new drop — Journey Finale already aired (Grade 8, Wk 37)</i>	<i>No new drop — season complete</i>